

A Mountain Mystery.

Parties returning from hunting trips to the mountains often tell strange tales of their experience when miles away from human habitation, of conflicts with grizzly bears, mountain lions, etc., but by far the most weird story we have heard is told by two well-known young men of this place, who were on a prospecting tour some time since near Cobblestone Mountain, at the northern boundary of this county. The story they tell—and they are willing to take their oath on the truth of the statement—is about as follows:

One cold night they were simultaneously awakened about 2 o'clock by the noise of crackling brush that had been thrown on the fire. They arose to a sitting posture and saw the figure of an Indian woman standing by the fire. She was dressed in a robe of gayly-colored material that almost reached to her feet. A glistening necklace, evidently of gold and silver, enriched her neck and hanging pendant from

evidently of gold and silver, enriched her neck, and hanging pendant from this were a number of bears' claws. Her black hair reached below her waist. In her ears were large hoop ear-rings of gold.

Upon seeing the form, one of the young men instinctively reached for his rifle by his side, while the other started in amazement at seeing such a sight in the dead of the night and thirty miles from any house. When the figure saw the motion made to reach the rifle she motioned for them not to fire and moved down the trail, beckoning to them. Before disappearing from view she again beckoned to them, but they were too dumfounded to follow.

The next morning they followed the trail, and after much difficulty traced the foot-prints to the base of a high cliff about a mile from their camp. The rest of the story is told to this effect: "When I awoke," said one of the young men, "I was horrified. I couldn't move to save my life. I was frozen with astonishment. The next morning we discussed the matter, and determined to investigate. So the next

morning we discussed the matter, and determined to investigate. So the next night we took our blankets and went to the base of the cliff. At about midnight, the same hour the figure appeared to us, we saw a bright phosphorescent light on the brow of the cliff, and I am sure we heard a voice calling "Meeneeah! Meeneeah!" several times. This is the strangest experience I ever passed through. I never have believed in ghosts, but I would like to know what this was. If it was a woman how did she come there at that time thirty miles from civilization?"

An old Indian tradition is to the effect that many, many years ago an Indian maiden—Meeneeah, the only daughter of a chief—was lost in this region and starved to death near the place called Squaw Flat. It is said that different camping parties have seen the phosphorescent light spoken of in the vicinity where these young men were camped. Can this be a parallel case with that of the Indian woman abandoned on San Nicholas Island for eighteen years?"—*Ventura (Cal.) Free Press.*
